



Charity donation intention via m-payment apps: donor-related, m-payment system-related, or charity brand-related factors, which one is overkill?

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Abstract

The purpose of this study is to examine the impact of donor-related factors (e.g., religiosity, and attitude toward helping others), m-payment system-related factors (system trust, and effort expectancy) and charity brand-related factors (a donor-brand engagement model) on the intention to donate via mobile payment applications (m-payment apps) and intention to recommend this function to others. Furthermore, importance-performance map analysis (IPMA) was used to list factors in order of priority to provide managerial insights. 523 donors of prior donation experiences from 9 charity organizations in Tehran participated in this study designed to gauge their intention to donate via m-payment apps and intention to recommend to others. PLS structural equation modeling was used to test the hypotheses of this study. The results indicated that donor-brand engagement, helper's high, and donor involvement fall into the "maintain quadrant for intention to donate via m-payment apps. Additionally, as religiosity has the lowest importance but relatively high performance, investing in this variable seems to be a wasted effort. Also, m-payment system-related factors have relatively low importance. So, they are not sufficient to motivate donors to donate via m-payment apps. Consequently, charity managers who are interested in expanding online donation via m-payment apps should prioritize improving the performance of the brand-related factors. Although religiosity may affect offline donation, its influence was insignificant in this study. It seems religious donors in this study seek visible or public displays of charity donation. This can be justified by pointing to the conspicuous consumption and need for social status.

Keywords Brand engagement · Charity reputation · Donation intention · Mobile payment apps · Religiosity

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1 Introduction

The ubiquity of mobile payment applications (m-payment apps) has fundamentally reshaped the process of some payment services. After the emergence of the 4th and 5th generation of mobile internet and smartphones, m-payment apps have proliferated over the recent years in Iran as a developing country. There are a variety of financial and payment services available in these apps. These services include bill payment, card to card transfer, inventory inquiry, and travel services, which enable users to send money remotely by using a mobile device. Charity is a new feature of m-payment apps in Iran as an online donation platform. In the charity section of m-payment, there is a shortlist of charities to which the users can choose to donate. After the selection of the respective charity, donors donate money using a bank card number and related password.

The function of charity donation is essentially different from the other services which are available in these m-payment apps. In other services, users receive financial benefits. As the charity organizations offer intangible services which the consumer (consumer in our study refers to the donor) does not consume (Meijer 2009), the factors that influence the charity donation intention via m-payment apps differ from those impacting the adoption intention of m-payment apps to receive the other services.

Bekkers and Wiepking (2011) identified eight different reasons for charitable donations. Their categorization is an extension of types of “costs and benefits” associated with motivation factors for a charitable donation. They indicated that even the physical comfort such as weather conditions affects people’s money donation possibilities. Moreover, in the context of consumption motives, the donation may be classified as an exchange. Due to the intangible services of charities for donors as consumers, social exchange plays an important role in consumers’ decision of donation (Venable et al. 2005). Donors’ behavior can be affected by pro-social self-attribution values, social approval, humanitarianism, or material benefits (Mitchell and Clark 2019). For example, when donations are announced in public or when donors are directly observable, reputation as the social consequences of donations is rewarded to the donors.

In addition, identification is related to donors engaging in supporting a non-profit organization (Kleinschafer, et al. 2018). A person’s identity is made up of narrower identities including self-identity and social identity. Social identity refers to individuals’ tendency to be identified with groups in their social environment, while self-identity is one’s characteristics as a particular individual.

So, payment methods which influence tangible and intangible costs and benefits, and donors’ identification would serve as a motivation factor for charitable donations. Considering the various existing mechanisms for donation decision-making, payment method (online payment vs. cash payment or unknown vs. observable) would contribute to donation intention.

There are some studies about online donation intention via online platforms and technology-mediated services, such as websites, blogs (Li 2017), social network sites (Chen 2018), and charity applications (Choi and Kim 2016). When individuals visit charity websites or blogs, the atmospheres of charity websites arouse visitors’ emotions and affect their donation intention and behavior. Charity websites or blogs can use appropriate colors, shading, text, imagery, and sound to encourage affective responses (Bennett 2006). Moreover, charity fundraising via online social networking sites and

crowd-funding is often about projects that may be initiated by a particular person, and initiator reputation can raise the number of potential donors (Liu et al. 2018). So donors can be influenced by the expectations of others and the desire to be a member of a community (Rodriguez-Ricardo et al. 2018; Choi et al. 2019). Crow-funding through social networks provides charities with an additional advantage (Cho et al. 2019). Besides, in seeking information about philanthropy, likely donors can interact with the organization on social networks, and charity organizations use this effective interaction to achieve their goal of collecting money for charity (Chen 2018). Also, donors can download the charity application, and by using functions of the installed apps, donate indirectly to a charity. In other words, donors donate in exchange for the functions of free applications (Choi and Kim 2016). But, factors impacting charity donation intention via m-payment apps have not yet been exactly clarified.

In the charity function of m-payment apps in Iran, there is no more information than the name of the branded charity. Managing charities as brands assists donors in differentiating between the charities and understanding what a charity stands for, and helps communicate value to their supporters (Wymer and Akbar 2019). In the context of charities, donor-brand relationships are value-based (Wymer and Akbar 2017). Brands are significant since they can acquire valuable donors and supporter relationships (Hudson 2008, p. 72). Charities are supported by donors whose values are in line with the charity's value. So, traits associated with the brands can impact donors' giving intention and behavior (Sargeant et al. 2008). A well-known charity brand to the target groups of donors is a strong brand that leads to a higher probability of donation intention (Wymer et al. 2016).

In m-payment apps, donors can choose from a shortlist of branded charities. Kull and Heath (2016) have shown that restricted cause choices (from a shortlist) strengthen consumer-brand relationships. When there is only a shortlist of charity brands on the apps and no further information given, the brand knowledge must come before the brand can be chosen. Moreover, according to the Zajonc's theory of mere exposure "mere repeated exposure of the individual to a stimulus is a sufficient condition for the enhancement of his attitude toward it (Zajonc 1968). So, the more the donor hears from the brand the bigger its chance to be chosen.

A shortlist of branded charities can strengthen donor-brand relationships. When a charity focuses on how the donors' need for social exchanges is met through donation, there will be a high level of engagement between the donors and the charity (Mitchell and Clark 2019). On the other hand, the charity's ambition to build strong relationships leads to donor-brand engagement (Smitko 2012). Higher donor engagement rates have a major impact on contributing to society and continuing their membership in a charity organization (Jarvis et al. 2017). Furthermore, studies offer charity reputation and donor involvement as drivers of donor-brand engagement (Bennett 2013, Algharabat et al. 2018). Involvement is defined as "an active interest in, engagement with, and commitment to a group or product (Hassay and Peloza 2009). When the donors have active involvement with the charity, then the level of donors' engagement will be high (Mitchell and Clark 2019). Thus, brand engagement can ensure donors' giving through affective commitment. Therefore, this research tests charity reputation and donor involvement as the antecedents and affective commitment and intention to donate via m-payment apps as a consequence of donor-brand engagement responding to the need

for more research that explores antecedents and consequences of donor-brand engagement in the context of donating via m-payment apps.

Moreover, donor-related factors can be important factors influencing donation via m-payment apps. Since the name of donors remains unknown while donating via m-payment apps, moral and internal emotions arouse the donors' behavioral intention, and donors are less influenced by externally-oriented arousal (Urbonavicius et al. 2019). Accordingly, helpers' high is an internal emotion that motivates donors. Helpers' high gives donors moral satisfaction and positive emotions as consequences of giving behavior (Bennett and Savani 2004). Also, a sense of inner reward and gratification from a positive attitude toward helping others are primary and important motives for donation activities (Briggs et al. 2010). Likewise, the literature shows in comparison to those who are not religious, the more religious the donors are, the more likely they are to donate to charity (Lwin et al. 2014; Tiltay and Torlak 2020). So donor-related factors including helpers' high, attitude toward helping others and religiosity may affect the donors' intention to donate via m-payment apps.

M-payment apps allow consumers the quick and easy transfer of money without the need for cash. Remote money transfer helps consumers to reduce operation time and location restrictions of cash transfer (Oliveira et al. 2016). In the m-payment transaction, the information passes back and forth to process the payment. This information includes personal financial information. Users should trust that the transaction processes are meet their expectations, and their financial and sensitive information will be shared only with the respective parties. So, in the context of monetary transactions via m-payment, the users' trust in m-payment systems plays an important role in predicting their intention to use m-payment services (Bailey et al. 2020). On the other hand, the users' intention to use m-payment systems depends on how easy it is to do so (Cao and Niu 2019). Moreover, technology-mediated charity donation focuses on easiness and convenience factors (Chen and Givens 2013). So, effort expectancy, ease of use of a system (Sivathanu 2019), can affect donors' intention to use m-payment for donating money to charities. Thus, system trust and effort expectancy can be considered an appeal of donation via the m-payment system.

However, in the literature there is research into donation intention via some online platforms. Still, donation via m-payment apps has not been studied, especially in developing countries. M-payment apps are different from other online donation platforms. In addition to being an unobservable donation method, m-payment apps are lacking in the atmosphere of charity websites, social network site interactions, and the free functions of application. So this study investigates how donor-related factors, m-payment system-related factors, and charity brand-related factors would affect the intention to donate via m-payment apps and intention to recommend it as a post-adoption behavior.

An understanding of users' donation intention via m-payment apps is important for charity organization managers to prioritize the factors in order of importance and to help them make the right marketing decisions and strategies to achieve their goals in collecting donations. Besides, users' m-payment app adoption intention is significant for app providers. In addition, intention to recommend a technological innovation is recognized as post-adoption behavior that is a tool for the success assessment of a new technology which arouses the interest of providers and app marketers (Miltgen et al. 2013; Oliveira et al. 2016). Thus, this research is going to focus on the factors that

affect intention to donate via m-payment apps and recommend this function to others in a religious developing country like Iran.

The combination of donor-related factors, system-related factors, and brand-related factors can provide a better understanding of the type of factors that affect donors' behavioral intentions. This paper is organized as follows. In the next section, the literature review and hypotheses investigated in the study are presented. In the third section, the measurement instrument, sampling, and data collection are described, while the final results of data analysis are in the fourth section. In the end, discussion of the results, conclusion, implications, and future research are presented.

2 Literature review and hypothesis development

The purpose of this study is to add to the knowledge of donation intention via m-payment apps. Therefore, it suggests a brand engagement model in the context of charitable donation and the relationship between the model and the intention to donate via m-payment apps and the intention to recommend this technology to others. Also, the literature was extended by examining the influence of donor-related factors, and system-related factors on the intention to donate via m-payment apps. The relationships are shown in Fig. 1. The focal constructs section presents definitions and previous research findings on these issues, and then the hypotheses are proposed.

2.1 A donor-brand engagement model

Brands are used to recognize the products and services of one producer and organization from those of competitors (Sargeant et al. 2008). Charity brands are also employed so that people can recognize the difference between a charity and its competitors. Due

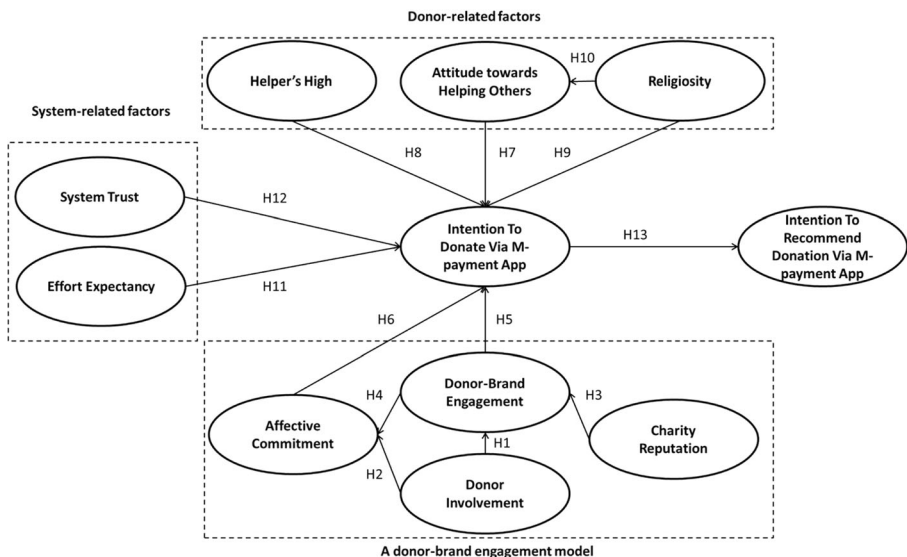


Fig. 1 Conceptual model

to the increasing number of charities and their competitiveness, brands are important in differentiating charitable organizations and achieving competitive advantage (Michel and Rieunier 2012; Randle et al. 2013). As there is no tangible product to sell, branding is critical for charities to communicate their services and values to donors as their consumers (Stebbins and Hartman 2013). Positive attitudes towards a charity brand leads to a higher level of donation behavior (Randle et al. 2013).

Brands are not passive entities, but the relation between brands and consumers is considered an interactive dynamic relationship (Algharabat et al. 2018). The concept of Consumer-brand engagement refers to consumer-brand relationship, which is psychological and interactive in nature. It encompasses a consumer's pride and passion for the brand, and rises from the strength of the consumer-brand relationship (France et al., 2016). The term "engagement" is used to express this developed relationship, which leads to a growth in the accounting rates of return and profitability, enriches performance outcomes, and improves consumers' significant contributions (Khan et al. 2016). Since brand-engaged consumers play an essential role in improving the performance of companies and organizations, brand-engagement should be given precedence in branding strategies (Stathopoulou et al. 2017). The engagement is also important for charities to connect donors emotionally to charities and their activities.

Some researchers have characterized the consumer-brand engagement as a three-dimensional variable including cognitive (a consumer level of using his/her mind to consider consumer-brand interaction carefully), affective (the emotional bond between consumer and brand), and behavioral (the level of time, effort or energy that the engaged consumer is prepared to invest in consumer-brand interaction) (Stathopoulou et al. 2017) or absorption (sense of being fully concentrated and happily engrossed in brand interactions, in which time passes quickly), dedication (sense of significance, enthusiasm, inspiration, pride, and challenge), and vigor (the willingness and the ability to invest effort in such interactions) (Dwivedi 2015). Therefore, engaged donors invest a high level of resources to the charity (Vigor), while they take pride in belonging to the charity and have a strong identification with it (Dedication) and are fascinated by the charity's activities (Absorption) (Bennett, 2013).

According to the threefold classification of Carvalho and Fernandes (2018), this study addresses the existing donors of branded charities as "engagement subject the brand of charities as "engagement object", and the charitable donations as the "engagement context". Thus, this study introduces the term donor-brand engagement taking into consideration the relationship between donors and brands as an important element in donation intention.

As charity organizations do not offer tangible products, there needs to be a strong and dynamic relationship between donors and brands. Therefore, a donor-brand engagement model related to donating via m-payment apps has to be explored. In this study, donor involvement and charity reputation are drivers of the donor-brand engagement model and the donors' affective commitment and the intention to donate via m-payment apps are the consequences (Fig. 1).

2.1.1 Drivers of donor-brand engagement

Different antecedents and consequences have been identified in the literature of consumer-brand engagement. The antecedents of donor-brand engagement within the

context of charitable donation via m-payment apps are donor involvement and charity reputation in this study. These constructs were adopted considering how important they are in creating donor-brand interactive relationships and individual experience in the context of charities as the service-dominant organizations (Bennett 2013; Algharabat et al. 2020). France et al. (2016) categorized the antecedents of consumer-brand engagement as firm-led and consumer-centered. In this study, donor involvement and charity reputation are investigated respectively as donor-centered and charity-led antecedents of donor-brand engagement.

Involvement is defined as the extent to which a consumer feels that a targeted object is consistent with his/her concerns, importance, values, and interests. A convergence of a consumer's personal relevance and a brand leads to the consumer-brand engagement, as a result of which the consumer is prepared to invest time, energy, thoughts, feelings, and actions in the brand (Carvalho and Fernandes 2018). Involved consumers feel a very strong liking for the brand. This strong feeling puts the involved consumers deep into a particular relevance to that brand and converts them to engaged consumers (France et al. 2016).

Based on what has been investigated by Bennett (2009), strong feelings of personal involvement with the charity could enhance the donors' inclination toward charitable donations. Becoming involved with a charity increases intangible benefits by increasing the donors' knowledge of and support for the charity's activities (Stebbins and Hartman 2013). In the context of donation, involved donors go beyond just giving donations and a superficial attachment and become engaged with the brand and even become a member of the charity brand community (Hassay and Peloza 2009). Likewise, Algharabat et al. (2018) have shown that involvement positively affects consumer-brand engagement in the context of non-profit organizations. So, the following hypothesis is posited in the context of charitable donation via m-payment apps in Iran:

H1. Donor involvement positively affects donor-brand engagement.

Involvement is studied as an effective factor in the process of identification. According to Bloemer and Odekerken-Schröder (2003), involvement is a situation in which consumers' values, needs, and self-images are recognized by an object which can be the brand or the service provider. The perceived relevance to the object leads to affective and emotional ties, and identification with an organization (Bennett 2013). On the other hand, affective commitment is a psychological attachment to an object and is associated with feelings and identification. Affective commitment captures the consumers' desire to maintain ties with the brand (Hassay and Peloza 2009; Vivek et al. 2012). Studies have shown that the affective form of commitment is developed by individual involvement (Bloemer and Odekerken-Schröder 2003; Rather et al. 2018). Likewise, involvement has been recognized as an indicator of donor commitment to charitable donation (Hassay and Peloza 2009). Furthermore, Merchant, Ford and Rose (2011) have shown that emotional benefits affect the donor's commitment. Affective commitment is an emotional factor, which evolves out of personal involvement, which contributes to a significant level of commitment (Rather et al. 2018). Thus, in the context of donation via m-payment apps, the following hypothesis is posited:

H2. Donor involvement positively affects the donors' affective commitment.

Based on the resource-based view, charity reputation can be a valuable, rare, and inimitable resource, which can create a competitive edge. Regarding the charity organizations that offer intangible service, the donors do not consume it; reputation plays a prominent role in the organization's success (Meijer 2009). In addition, an individual's perspective on the organization's reputation is a part of his/her experience of the organization. Reputation strengthens a close psychological bond between individuals and organizations, which exerts considerable influence over the perceived relationship quality (Bennett 2013). Hence, the good opinion that people have about the organization, mainly based on the experience they have had with the organization, leads to high levels of engagement. Accordingly, Bennett (2013) has shown in the context of offline donation that donors are more willing to engage with the charities which have a good reputation. Thus, in the context of donation via m-payment apps, the following hypothesis is posited:

H3. Charity reputation positively affects donor-brand engagement.

2.1.2 The consequences of donor-brand engagement

Examination of the consequences of donor-brand engagement has an important value in helping charities reach their goals of collecting donations. Marketing researchers have noticed that consumer-brand engagement is an antecedent of the consumers' affective commitment (Vivek et al. 2012). According to relationship marketing theory, perceptions of the strength of the relationship shape the consumers' behavior and intention in that relationship (Jeng 2016). When consumers experience positive emotions as a result of a strong relationship with the brand—conceptualized as consumer-brand engagement—there would be a tendency to behave in a way that leads to a more heightened consumer-brand relationship (Fang 2017). Affective commitment is an important factor that serves as the strength of the relationship, which is defined as a psychological desire to remain attached to the partner-brand relationship (Vivek et al. 2012; Jeng 2016). In the context of branded charities, affective commitment as a psychological inclination toward the continuity of a relationship guarantees the donors' efforts to maintain the relationship. Thus affective commitment can be a consequence of donor-brand engagement. So, the following hypothesis is posited:

H4. Donor-brand engagement positively affects the donors' affective commitment.

The investment of the preferred self of the consumer is an outcome linked to engagement (Kumar and Nayak 2019). Engaged donors find their interaction with the charity a meaningful one. Their interaction with the charity is meaningful, mainly because their investments are rewarded physically, cognitively, or emotionally. In this case, donors are affectively committed to the charity and are prepared to invest resources, including thought, emotion, time, money, and energy. So, a meaningful interactive relationship between donors, as consumers of charities, and the brand of charities would make the donors more willing to invest their resources. Thus, the charities emotionally engage

consumers when appealing for donations (Merchant et al. 2011). Algharabat et al. (2018) have indicated that engagement with a non-profit organization Facebook page (the brand) raises the probability of members' willingness to donate. In addition, Bennett (2013) suggested that an actively engaged donor intends to offer more support in the future. Hence, in the context of donation via m-payment apps, the following hypothesis is posited:

H5. Donor-brand engagement positively affects intention to donate via m-payment apps.

2.2 Affective commitment and intention to donate via m-payment apps

According to relationship marketing, commitment is a key-mediating construct which links evaluative variables to intentional variables (Fullerton, 2005). Donor commitment has been recognized as a predictor of charitable donation (Sargeant et al. 2006; Alhidari et al. 2018). In studies of marketing relationships, commitment is usually operationalized as affective commitment (Fullerton 2005). So, donor affective commitment can be critical for the charity when trying to raise funds. As affective commitment is based on the shared values, identification, and attachment (Fullerton 2005; Erciş et al. 2012), affectively committed donors are inclined to support or give money to the charity to which they feel attached and with which they identify, and they desire to maintain the relationship. On the other hand, Meng et al. (2016) have emphasized the significant positive effect of affective commitment on users' behavioral intention in the context of online crowd-funding. So, the rationale behind the impact of affective commitment on donation can be logical for intention to donate via m-payment apps. So, the following hypothesis is posited:

H6. Affective commitment positively affects intention to donate via m-payment apps.

2.3 Donors-related factors and intention to donate via m-payment apps

Donating to a charity requires certain motivations and incentives. There are different internalized and externalized motivations for charitable donation intention. However, when donors remain unknown, their primary motivation may be restricted to internalized motivation. Donors do not reveal their identity while donating via m-payment apps. So, since there is no external recognition, donation intention is influenced by internalized motivation (Urbonavicius et al. 2019). Donation intention via m-payment apps could be influenced by moral emotions, internalized moral values, or feelings that are experienced or felt internally.

The donors' strong desire to achieve "do the right thing", justifies seeking moral satisfaction. Also, people show a positive attitude toward helping others to experience positive inner emotions (Human and Terblanche 2012). Attitude toward helping others is defined as a relatively enduring judgment about helping, supporting, or assisting other people, which include a wide range of donation behaviors (Rodriguez-Ricardo

et al., 2018). Attitude toward helping others judges individuals on their personal norms, internalized values, and beliefs in a charitable act (Moriuchi and Chung 2018). Attitude toward a particular behavior is a reliable index of behavioral intention. The aspiration of helping others has been acknowledged as an important motivator for charitable acts (Webb et al. 2000). Positives attitude toward helping others could be derived from the donors' basic beliefs, inner empathy, and personal norms (Wymer and Akbar 2019). So, a sympathetic attitude toward helping others may be predictive of charity donation intentions via m-payment apps.

H7. Attitude toward helping others positively affects intention to donate via m-payment apps.

On the other hand, people look for experiencing “the warm glow of giving”. “The inner warm glow refers to the construct of helper’s high as an experience following charitable donation, an experience that leads to pleasurable emotions and personal satisfaction that make the donor’s life a better one (Bennett 2018). Considering helper’s high, a charitable donation is interpreted as the monetary purchase of moral satisfaction, and an internal sense of well-being (Bennett 2006). So, the helper’s high is just like giving something to yourself. Helper’s high, the feeling of calmness and inner self-worth as a consequence of helping others, is said to be a donor-related reason for charitable donations. As a result, this study proposes the following hypothesis.

H8. Helpers’ high positively affects the intention to donate via m-payment apps.

Moreover, religion as a social-cultural system with specific morals and spirituals for its followers plays an important role in giving attitude, intention, and behavior (Noor, et al. 2015; Tiltay and Torlak 2020). Religiosity is defined as the belief in God and the extent to which a person lives out his or her religious rules and principles (Muralidharan and La Ferle, 2018). Religion and charitable donation intention and behavior have been studied in charity studies inseparably (Rajan et al. 2009; Lwin et al. 2014). Religiosity is considered a spiritual reason based on the spiritual values of individuals for charitable activities. The loyal persons to religious values are more willing to donate (Tiltay and Torlak 2020). Peoples’ religious values, which become their self-worth, affect their donation intention (Arli and Lasmono 2015). In Iran, as a Muslim country, donation patterns have been shaped by religion. The importance of religion and rituals are undeniable in Iranian people’s lives. Receiving a return on charity in the afterlife can be a driver of donation motivations (Skarmeas and Shabbir 2011). So:

H9. Religiosity positively affects intention to donate via m-payment apps.

Moreover, all major religions have taught the importance of giving behaviors and have encouraged helping others (Arli & Lasmono, 2015; Tiltay & Torlak, 2020). So, more religious individuals feel that they have a duty to others (Hopkins et al., 2014). There are mandatory and optional charitable contributions in Islam for all Muslims who meet the necessary criteria of wealth (Rizal & Amin, 2017). So, this study assumes that in Iran, as a Muslim country, religiosity affects donors’ attitudes toward helping others. The following hypothesis is posited:

H10. Religiosity positively affects the attitude toward helping others.

2.4 M-payment system-related factors and intention to donate via m-payment apps

The widespread use of smartphones and mobile Internet has driven people to use m-payment apps for receiving different services. M-payment apps as an innovative technology are being applied to pay money for a wide range of products and services. These apps are able to perform various improved functionalities. New payment technologies are important for product and service providers (Sharma et al. 2019). The charity organizations are non-profit service providers who have recently started using m-payment apps for online donation fundraising in Iran. As previous research suggested that technological characteristics (Liu et al., 2018) and Internet technology features (Sura et al. 2017) are important factors in online donation via websites, m-payment system-related factors can be important factors for the donors' intention to donate via m-payment apps. In the context of charitable donation, the donors' intention behavior may be affected by how easily they can use m-payment apps and to what extent they trust the m-payment system.

Effort expectancy is the degree of ease associated with consumers' use of technology, which can motivate or restrict m-payment usage (Oliveira et al. 2016). The ease of technology usage is admitted and accepted, which affects the intention to adopt the m-payment technology (Zhou 2014; Sivathanu 2019). Li et al. (2018) recognized that the convenience of donating via online crowd-funding platforms and the ease of the operation process positively affect the intention of users to donate. Thus, when donors perceive that donation via m-payment apps does not necessitate much effort, they will intend to use these apps for donating money. Thus:

H11. Effort expectancy positively affects the intention to donate via m-payment apps.

Moreover, the individuals' intention to donate via m-payment apps may be affected by their trust in the m-payment system. Chiefly, trust is defined as a strong belief in the honesty and goodness of "others, who will not behave opportunistically to gain unfair advantages. Trust in the "other will lead to a positive behavioral intention toward him/her (Chemingui and Ben lallouna 2013). In the context of monetary transactions via m-payment apps, users expect that money will be exchanged for products or services, and their information will be shared only with related parties. Lu et al. (2011) believed that in comparison to traditional money transactions, m-payments are more vulnerable, and thus, involve more potential risk. Therefore, the assessment of users' trust in m-payment systems is important for m-payment providers (Bailey et al. 2020). Likewise, the donors' trust in online payment platforms has been acknowledged to be one of the critical antecedents of the intention to donate to a crowd-funding project (Li et al. 2018). So, evaluating the level of donors' trust in the m-payment system can predict the level of the donors' intention to donate via m-payment apps.

H12. System trust positively affects the intention to donate via m-payment apps.

2.5 The donors' intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps

The intention to recommend a technological innovation has been considered an evaluation of the success of new technology. Recommending a technology to others is a positive word of mouth in which providers and marketer are interested (Miltgen et al. 2013). Studies have shown that consumers with a higher intention to use the technology are more likely to actually use it and then recommend it to others (Oliveira et al., 2016). Hence, the intention to recommend a technology is a type of post-adoption behavior, which is vital if the technology is to stand out among its competitors (Verkijika 2020). Charitable donation services are a recent addition to m-payment apps in Iran. The acceptance and usage of this function can have more than individual acceptance (Miltgen et al. 2013), as word of mouth and recommending intention can be applied to spread information, ideas, opinions, experiences, and even behavior to as many people as possible. Thus, this study proposes the intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps as the consequence of the intention to donate via m-payment apps.

H13. The intention to donate via m-payment apps positively affects the intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps.

3 Methodology

3.1 Measurement instrument

The measurement instrument consisted of two sections of demographic questions (items for gender, education, age, and income) and open-ended questions about research variables. The second section included 47 items to measure the variables of the research model. The preliminary questionnaire was translated into Persian. To be sure of the face and content validity of the translated questionnaire and to make items free from complexity or ambiguity (As a procedural remedy for common method bias), content validity index (CVI), and content validity ratio (CVR) were conducted through a panel of experts. The questionnaire items were measured with a 5-point, Likert-type, from strongly disagree (1) to strongly agree (5). Since the data was collected from single respondents in a one-time survey, the common method bias (CMB) had to be assessed. So, procedural (Preventive techniques) and statistical methods were used to control the potential common method bias (Podsakoff et al. 2003). The respondents were assured that they would remain anonymous. For psychological separation, as a way to control CMB (Jordan and Troth 2020), the respondents were asked some questions between the independent and dependent variables. Measurement scales were standard and established measurements were adapted from previous studies (see Table 1). The questionnaire was pre-tested among 30 respondents from the study population to avoid misunderstandings.

3.2 Sampling and data collection

Data collection was done through the questionnaires that were distributed face to face and online. Due to their popularity, twelve charity organizations in Tehran, to which donors can donate money via m-payment apps, were contacted for data collection. Nine of these organizations cooperated with this study. The questionnaire started with two screening questions. First, the donors were asked about the frequency of their donations to the charity. Since past behavior is a predictor of future intention to donate (Michaelidou et al. 2015), donors who had made three or more donations to the same charity over the past year were included. According to the interview with charity managers, three or more donations to the charity are equated with brand engagement and commitment to the charity. Then, the respondents were asked if they had ever donated money via m-payment apps. Respondents were asked to answer questions for the charity which they currently supported. Also, if the respondent passed the screening questions and completed the questionnaire, he/she was asked to extend the survey participation invitation to other donors who would then be included in the sample. A total of 560 respondents answered the survey from the 1st to the 20th of December 2019. However, the responses of 37 questionnaires were excluded from the analysis due to missing data and straight-lining. The demographic information of the respondents is shown in Table 2.

4 Data analysis and findings

The data analysis was conducted in SPSS 23 and SmartPLS 3. A systematic evaluation of partial least squares structural equation modeling (PLS-SEM) followed the assessments of the measurement models and the structural model. PLS-SEM supports the complex model and the use of variable scores in a subsequent analysis such as importance-performance matrix analysis (Hair Jr et al. 2016, p. 23). This study extends the research model analysis by performing IPMA in SmartPLS to prioritize the antecedent factors for the intention to donate via m-payment apps drawn on the two dimensions of importance and performance.

4.1 Common method Bias

Since the data was collected from single respondents in a one-time survey, three post-hoc statistical techniques including Harman's single-factor test, correlation marker technique, and full collinearity variance inflation factors (VIF) were conducted to check for CMB. Harman's single-factor test indicates CMB as an issue if an exploratory factor analysis with all study variables produces eigenvalues suggesting the first factor accounts for more than 50%. In this study, the total variance for a single factor is 30.00% and less than 50%; this suggests that CMB does not affect the data. Also, to conduct the correlation marker technique (Lindell and Whitney 2001), eye color (light or dark) as theoretically unrelated to the dependent variables was added as a marker variable. The results show that the correlation between the marker variable and the study's principal variables in the proposed model was very low. Furthermore, the full collinearity test was assessed to generate VIFs for all latent variables in the model.

Table 1 Constructs and their scale items

Constructs	Scale items
Affective commitment (Fullerton 2005)	AC1. I feel emotionally attached to the charity. AC2. The charity has a great deal of personal meaning for me. AC3. I feel a strong sense of identification with the charity.
Attitude towards helping others (Mittelman and Rojas-Méndez 2018)	ATH1. People should be willing to help others who are less fortunate. ATH2. Helping troubled people with their problems is very important to me. ATH3. People should be more charitable towards others in society. ATH4. People in need should receive support from others.
Donor-brand engagement (Lee et al. 2018)	BE1. I have a special bond with this brand. BE2. I consider this brand to be a part of myself. BE3. I often feel a personal connection between this brand and me. BE4. Part of me is defined by this brand in my life. BE5. I feel as if I have a close personal connection with this brand. BE6. I can identify with this brand in my life. BE7. There are links between this brand and how I view myself. BE8. This brand is an important indication of who I am.
Charity reputation (Bennett 2013)	CR1. The charity is very well-respected among the general public. CR2. The charity has an excellent reputation among the general public for assisting its beneficiaries. CR3. The charity has an excellent reputation among the general public for managing its finances wisely. CR4. The charity has an excellent reputation among the general public for being competent and generally well-managed.
donor involvement (Bennett 2009)	DI1. Giving to this charity means a great deal to me DI2. Giving to this charity is a vitally important part of my life. DI3. I am deeply interested in the work of the charity I support even when I am not able to make a donation. DI4. I feel heavily involved with the good causes to which I donate. DI5. I am fascinated by the work of the charity I support.
Effort expectancy (Li et al. 2018)	EF1. The structure and design of the interaction function of the m-payment apps' donation services is clear and easy to understand. EF2. It is convenient to donate to charity donation via the m-payment app. EF3. It is easy for me to use m-payment apps' donation services. EF4. I can easily use m-payment apps to donate.
Helper's high (Bennett 2009)	HH1. Donating to charity gives me a lot of pleasure.

Table 1 (continued)

Constructs	Scale items
Intention to donate via m-payment app (Kwak et al. 2018)	HH2. I would feel guilty if I did not give money to charity.
	HH3. I feel uplifted after making a donation to charity.
	HH4. I obtain deep inherent satisfaction from giving to charity.
	HH5. Giving to charity makes my own life better.
	ID1. I intend to donate money to this charity via M-payment app.
intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps (Oliveira et al. 2016)	ID2. I predict that I will donate money to this charity via M-payment app.
	ID3. I am willing to donate money to this charity via M-payment app.
	IR1. I will recommend to others to subscribe to a mobile payment system to donation.
	IR2. If I have a good experience with M-payment I will recommend others to subscribe to a mobile payment system to donation.
Religiosity (Muralidharan and La Ferle 2018)	R1. My religion forms an important basis for the kind of person I want to be.
	R2. My ideas on religion have a big influence on my views in other areas.
	R3. Were I to think about religion differently, my whole life would be very different.
	R4. I often think about religious matters.
	R5. My religion is one of the most important parts of my philosophy of life.
System trust (Bailey et al. 2020)	ST1. I trust M-payment systems to be reliable.
	ST2. I trust M-payment payment systems to be secure.
	ST3. I believe M-payment payment systems are trustworthy.
	ST4. I trust M-payment payment systems.

Results from the full collinearity test are lower than 3.3 or close to 3.3 and less than 5.0 (see Table 2), which can be still acceptable, and the model can be considered free of the common method bias (Kock, 2015, Hair Jr et al. 2016).

Table 2 Respondents' profile

Age	pct.	Gender	pct.	Income	pct.	Education	pct.
18–25 years old	5.2	Male	64.2	1–2 million	4.2	Non-college	17.4
26–32 years old	12.4	Female	35.6	2–3 million	14.3	Bachelor	31.5
33–39 years old	35.2	Missing	0.2	3–4 million	37.5	Master	37.1
40–46 years old	34.2			4–5 million	30.2	PhD	13.0
More than 46 years old	12.4			more than 5 million	13.4	Missing	1.0
Missing	0.6			Missing	0.4		

4.2 Measurement model evaluation

The measurement model evaluation of PLS-SEM estimates the reliability and validity of the construct measures. The evaluation of the reflective measurement models includes internal consistency, convergent validity, and discriminant validity (Hair Jr et al. 2016).

Cronbach's α , composite reliability (CR), and Dijkstra–Henseler's rho are reported to evaluate the internal consistency of latent variables. According to the minimum threshold of 0.7 for the three criteria (Hair Jr et al. 2016), the internal consistency reliability of the constructs was confirmed (Table 3).

Furthermore, convergent validity is assessed according to the reliability of indicators (outer loadings) and the average variance extracted (AVE) from the constructs. Taking into account the minimum threshold of 0.7 for the factor loadings of the indicators, all indicators are reliable. Also, due to the threshold of 0.50 for AVE, the model's convergent validity was approved (Table 3).

Finally, the discriminant validity of the constructs is assessed by cross loading tests, Fornell–Larcker criterion, and Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT) approach. According to cross-loading tests, the own loadings of each construct should be higher than (at least 0.2) the cross-loadings with other constructs (Table 4).

The Fornell–Larcker criterion requires that the constructs share more variance with their indicators than with any other construct. So the squared AVE of the construct should be higher the correlations between constructs (Table 5).

Also, due to the maximum threshold of 0.85 for HTMT (Henseler et al. 2015), the results approved the discriminant validity of the constructs (Table 6).

4.3 Assessment of structural model

After confirming the measurement model validity and reliability, a systematic approach to the assessment of the structural model includes the assessment of collinearity, the significance and relevance of the structural model relationships (Hypothesis testing), the level of R squared, the f^2 effect size, and the predictive relevance Q^2 (Hair Jr et al. 2016, p. 206). Moreover, the full VIF is measured to assess the collinearity. As the VIF values were below 5, it was confirmed that collinearity is not a problem (Hair Jr et al. 2016).

The results of testing the hypotheses are shown in Table 7. Ten of the thirteen hypotheses were supported. Results indicate that donor-brand engagement, affective commitment, attitude toward helping others, helper's high, and system trust are significant antecedents of intention to donate via m-payment apps lending support to H5, H6, H7, H8, and H12. Also, donor involvement and charity reputation significantly affect donor-brand engagement, which means that H1 and H3 were supported. Moreover, H2 and H4, which predicted that donor-brand engagement and donor involvement significantly influence affective commitment, were supported. But the effect of religiosity on the intention to donate via m-payment apps, and attitude toward helping others are insignificant, which is counter to H9 and H10. Furthermore, effort expectancy does not influence the intention to donate via m-payment apps, which is counter to H11. Finally, the intention to donate via m-payment apps significantly affects the intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps, lending support to H13.

Table 3 Measurement model assessment

Construct	Items	Factor Loading	Weights	Cronbachs Alpha	rho_A	CR	AVE	VIF
Affective commitment	AC1	0.902	0.376	0.848	0.852	0.908	0.767	1.804
	AC2	0.872	0.409					
	AC3	0.852	0.356					
Attitude towards Helping Others	ATH1	0.741	0.324	0.835	0.837	0.89	0.671	1.868
	ATH2	0.827	0.295					
	ATH3	0.834	0.275					
	ATH4	0.869	0.33					
Donor-brand engagement	BE1	0.76	0.155	0.903	0.906	0.922	0.596	3.805
	BE2	0.765	0.151					
	BE3	0.755	0.161					
	BE4	0.759	0.151					
	BE5	0.738	0.144					
	BE6	0.8	0.172					
	BE7	0.822	0.174					
	BE8	0.773	0.185					
Charity reputation	CR1	0.807	0.256	0.838	0.878	0.886	0.661	2.274
	CR2	0.822	0.27					
	CR3	0.849	0.265					
	CR4	0.773	0.448					
donor involvement	DI1	0.799	0.262	0.839	0.849	0.886	0.608	3.317
	DI2	0.754	0.226					
	DI3	0.727	0.218					
	DI4	0.812	0.303					
	DI5	0.804	0.267					
Effort expectancy	EF1	0.774	0.293	0.794	0.795	0.866	0.618	1.625
	EF2	0.822	0.324					
	EF3	0.766	0.319					
	EF4	0.781	0.336					
Helper's high	HH1	0.813	0.246	0.881	0.883	0.913	0.677	1.940
	HH2	0.817	0.211					
	HH3	0.863	0.261					
	HH4	0.825	0.252					
	HH5	0.795	0.245					
Intention to donate via m-payment app	ID1	0.739	0.4	0.75	0.752	0.858	0.67	2.337
	ID2	0.848	0.404					
	ID3	0.862	0.42					
intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps	IR1	0.939	0.56	0.85	0.855	0.93	0.869	1.334
	IR2	0.926	0.512					
Religiosity	R1	0.823	0.337	0.884	0.943	0.911	0.671	1.016
	R2	0.79	0.128					
	R3	0.819	0.15					

Table 3 (continued)

Construct	Items	Factor Loading	Weights	Cronbachs Alpha	rho_A	CR	AVE	VIF
System trust	R4	0.796	0.23					
	R5	0.864	0.365					
	ST1	0.704	0.195	0.798	0.827	0.866	0.618	1.053
	ST2	0.854	0.398					
	ST3	0.788	0.32					
	ST4	0.793	0.342					

However, acceptable R^2 values depend on model complexity, and research discipline (Hair Jr et al. 2016, p. 214), the R^2 values of donor-brand engagement (0.653), and the intention to donate (0.549) can be considered strong, while the R^2 value of affective commitment (0.429) can be considered moderate, whereas the R^2 value of the intention to recommend (0.152) and attitude towards helping others (0.001) are rather weak.

As shown in Table 8, the Q^2 values of all endogenous constructs are above zero, which provides support for the model's predictive relevance regarding the endogenous latent variables.

Total effects, effect sizes f^2 , are presented in Table 9. F^2 values are defined as 0.02 (small), 0.15 (medium), and 0.35 (large), so all variables show at least a small effect size except the effect of religiosity on attitude toward helping others. The highest f^2 is linked the effect of donor involvement on donor-brand engagement, followed by the impact of charity reputation on donor-brand engagement.

Due to a conservative approach, the SRMR value of less than 0.08 indicates a good fit (Hair Jr et al. 2016). The model's SRMR is 0.062, which shows a good fit.

4.4 IPMA results

The IPMA focuses on identifying antecedents that have relatively high importance but also a relatively low performance for the target construct. This analysis highlights the area that needs great attention. The IPMA includes four quadrants: “concentrate here represents factors of high importance but a low performance, where focus should be on the improvement of those factors; “maintain represents factors of high importance and high performance, which should remain as they are; “possible overkill represents factors of low importance but high performance; and “lower priority represents factors of low importance and low performance (Streukens et al. 2017).

To conduct IPMA in SmartPLS, three requirements need to be checked. First, all the indicators are checked to be metrics and have the same coding (minimum value represents the worst outcome, and the maximum value represents the best outcome of an indicator). Second, all the weights of the scales must be positive. Third, VIF values need to be checked to be below 5 (Ringle and Sarstedt 2016). According to the results in Table 3, all requirements are met.

The IPMA result for the intention to donate via m-payment apps is in Table 10 and Fig. 2. The importance value is the total effects of antecedent constructs on the intention to donate via m-payment apps, and the performance value is the latent variable score on

Table 4 Cross loadings

Questions	Affective Commitment	Attitude towards Helping	Brand Engagement	Charity Reputation	Donor Involvement	Effort Expectancy	Helper's High	Intention To Donate	Intention To Recommend	To Religiosity	System Trust
AC1	0.902	0.347	0.527	0.375	0.532	0.335	0.454	0.447	0.226	-0.01	0.056
AC2	0.872	0.43	0.564	0.46	0.59	0.399	0.459	0.486	0.216	0.003	0.074
AC3	0.852	0.293	0.47	0.313	0.502	0.325	0.388	0.456	0.22	-0.06	0.058
ATH1	0.35	0.741	0.547	0.45	0.452	0.354	0.438	0.461	0.278	0.077	0.108
ATH2	0.277	0.827	0.543	0.476	0.409	0.247	0.345	0.423	0.335	0.01	0.075
ATH3	0.338	0.834	0.521	0.379	0.419	0.231	0.332	0.395	0.335	-0.007	0.082
ATH4	0.371	0.869	0.537	0.399	0.436	0.235	0.345	0.472	0.301	0.024	0.053
BE1	0.434	0.501	0.76	0.564	0.497	0.365	0.381	0.493	0.376	0.03	0.061
BE2	0.454	0.419	0.765	0.569	0.513	0.359	0.421	0.395	0.312	0.002	0.023
BE3	0.53	0.505	0.755	0.6	0.489	0.354	0.412	0.447	0.353	0.015	0.118
BE4	0.414	0.52	0.759	0.531	0.496	0.304	0.382	0.489	0.35	0.01	0.045
BE5	0.396	0.482	0.738	0.51	0.455	0.251	0.394	0.488	0.358	0.006	0.06
BE6	0.455	0.552	0.8	0.525	0.628	0.295	0.495	0.594	0.323	-0.03	0.043
BE7	0.43	0.544	0.822	0.535	0.626	0.342	0.47	0.634	0.385	0.021	0.15
BE8	0.555	0.527	0.773	0.533	0.752	0.449	0.508	0.522	0.332	0.018	0.023
CR1	0.241	0.353	0.441	0.807	0.363	0.375	0.26	0.365	0.325	-0.01	0.133
CR2	0.351	0.403	0.465	0.822	0.487	0.435	0.348	0.423	0.31	0.051	0.069
CR3	0.324	0.38	0.457	0.849	0.469	0.487	0.34	0.394	0.232	0.014	0.066
CR4	0.444	0.496	0.773	0.773	0.518	0.367	0.409	0.48	0.38	0.019	0.08
D11	0.508	0.386	0.564	0.524	0.799	0.449	0.47	0.578	0.266	-0.019	0.062
D12	0.485	0.402	0.448	0.391	0.754	0.449	0.509	0.557	0.167	-0.005	0.111
D13	0.425	0.329	0.467	0.321	0.727	0.377	0.607	0.447	0.191	-0.052	0.064

Table 4 (continued)

Questions	Affective Commitment	Attitude towards Helping	Brand Engagement	Charity Reputation	Donor Involvement	Effort Expectancy	Helper's High	Intention To Donate	Intention To Recommend	To Religiosity	System Trust
DI4	0.503	0.479	0.725	0.522	0.812	0.471	0.527	0.542	0.3	0.03	0.007
DI5	0.494	0.437	0.595	0.472	0.804	0.466	0.465	0.452	0.275	-0.022	-0.005
EF1	0.29	0.249	0.32	0.339	0.389	0.774	0.308	0.295	0.141	-0.017	0.035
EF2	0.346	0.272	0.387	0.403	0.443	0.822	0.326	0.327	0.123	-0.013	0.061
EF3	0.255	0.294	0.322	0.44	0.489	0.766	0.281	0.322	0.194	-0.022	0.006
EF4	0.378	0.22	0.361	0.406	0.462	0.781	0.335	0.338	0.114	-0.047	0.104
HH1	0.413	0.313	0.481	0.374	0.518	0.307	0.813	0.492	0.282	-0.089	0.077
HH2	0.349	0.331	0.404	0.329	0.458	0.292	0.817	0.422	0.196	-0.031	0.054
HH3	0.461	0.398	0.492	0.413	0.524	0.356	0.863	0.523	0.252	0.016	0.077
HH4	0.409	0.374	0.481	0.328	0.587	0.34	0.825	0.506	0.222	-0.001	0.06
HH5	0.4	0.423	0.455	0.334	0.596	0.337	0.795	0.489	0.196	0.036	0.121
ID1	0.498	0.394	0.441	0.396	0.595	0.437	0.511	0.739	0.242	-0.039	0.16
ID2	0.416	0.469	0.564	0.413	0.515	0.28	0.444	0.848	0.338	-0.037	0.166
ID3	0.386	0.456	0.614	0.482	0.511	0.288	0.5	0.862	0.374	-0.021	0.144
IR1	0.25	0.366	0.436	0.371	0.285	0.18	0.266	0.38	0.939	-0.074	0.097
IR2	0.219	0.342	0.404	0.372	0.3	0.157	0.257	0.347	0.926	-0.043	0.085
R1	-0.01	0.028	-0.002	0.022	-0.029	-0.044	-0.016	-0.044	-0.044	0.823	-0.044
R2	-0.025	0.023	0.042	-0.017	0.007	-0.044	0.014	-0.006	-0.045	0.79	-0.049
R3	-0.034	0.006	0.021	0.003	-0.012	-0.027	-0.003	-0.025	-0.043	0.819	-0.007
R4	-0.048	-0.007	-0.009	0.017	-0.009	-0.038	-0.044	-0.052	-0.06	0.796	0.013
R5	-0.004	0.06	0.015	0.038	-0.005	0.004	-0.005	-0.022	-0.063	0.864	-0.03
ST1	0.04	0.03	-0.003	0.033	0.017	0.021	0.036	0.09	0.015	-0.068	0.704
ST2	0.074	0.092	0.089	0.101	0.052	0.088	0.08	0.183	0.101	0.001	0.854

Table 4 (continued)

Questions	Affective Commitment	Attitude towards Helping	Brand Engagement	Charity Reputation	Donor Involvement	Effort Expectancy	Helper's High	Intention To Donate	Intention To Recommend	To Religiosity	System Trust
ST3	0.038	0.08	0.052	0.039	0.015	0.033	0.057	0.147	0.109	-0.022	0.788
ST4	0.066	0.085	0.098	0.137	0.08	0.05	0.111	0.157	0.06	-0.03	0.793

Table 5 Discriminant validity-Fornell-Larcker Criterion

	Affective Commitment	Attitude towards Helping	Brand Engagement	Charity Reputation	Donor Involvement	Effort Expectancy	Helper's High	Intention To Donate	Intention To Recommend	Religiosity	System Trust
Affective Commitment	0.876										
Attitude towards Helping	0.411	0.819									
Brand Engagement	0.597	0.658	0.772								
Charity Reputation	0.441	0.522	0.706	0.813							
Donor Involvement	0.62	0.526	0.73	0.58	0.78						
Effort Expectancy	0.405	0.329	0.443	0.507	0.569	0.786					
Helper's High	0.496	0.448	0.564	0.433	0.655	0.398	0.823				
Intention To Donate	0.529	0.538	0.662	0.528	0.661	0.409	0.594	0.818			
Intention To Recommend	0.252	0.38	0.451	0.399	0.313	0.182	0.28	0.39	0.932		
Religiosity	-0.024	0.034	0.011	0.023	-0.014	-0.032	-0.016	-0.039	-0.064	0.819	
System Trust	0.072	0.097	0.085	0.106	0.056	0.067	0.095	0.191	0.098	-0.03	0.786

Table 6 Heterotrait-Monotrait Ratio (HTMT)

	Affective Commitment	Attitude towards Helping	Brand Engagement	Charity Reputation	Donor Involvement	Effort Expectancy	Helper's High	Intention To Donate	Intention To Recommend	To Religiosity
Attitude towards Helping	0.481									
Brand Engagement	0.676	0.754								
Charity Reputation	0.486	0.593	0.749							
Donor Involvement	0.731	0.62	0.814	0.658						
Effort Expectancy	0.489	0.401	0.519	0.62	0.692					
Helper's High	0.569	0.518	0.626	0.479	0.765	0.474				
Intention To Donate	0.664	0.676	0.798	0.639	0.834	0.531	0.728			
Intention To Recommend	0.296	0.452	0.515	0.45	0.364	0.221	0.322	0.487		
Religiosity	0.046	0.057	0.036	0.034	0.04	0.05	0.053	0.053	0.07	
System Trust	0.084	0.112	0.106	0.133	0.086	0.088	0.107	0.237	0.109	0.056

Table 7 Summary of the structural model

Hypotheses Paths	P a t h Coefficients	T - Values	P Values	Results
H1: Donor involvement→ donor-brand engagement	0.483	11.812	0.000	Supported
H2: Donor involvement→ donors' affective commitment	0.395	6.321	0.000	Supported
H3: Charity reputation→ donor-brand engagement	0.426	10.393	0.000	Supported
H4: Donor-brand engagement→ donors' affective commitment	0.308	4.81	0.000	Supported
H5: Donor-brand engagement→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.32	6.189	0.000	Supported
H6: Affective commitment→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.122	2.708	0.007	Supported
H7: Attitude toward helping others→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.132	3.027	0.002	Supported
H8: Helpers' high→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.257	6.253	0.000	Supported
H9: Religiosity→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	-0.035	1.181	0.238	Not Supported
H10: Religiosity→ attitude toward helping others	0.034	0.482	0.63	Not Supported
H11: Effort expectancy→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.063	1.467	0.143	Not Supported
H12: System trust→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.113	3.145	0.002	Supported
H13: Intention to donate via m-payment apps→ intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps	0.39	10.624	0.000	Supported

a scale from 0 to 100. The highest performances belong to religiosity. Also, donor-brand engagement is the variable with the highest importance for the intention to donate via m-payment apps. According to Fig. 2, donor-brand engagement, helper's high, and donor involvement fall into the 'maintain' quadrant for target construct. Also, m-payment system-related factors are positioned in the quadrant of 'possible overkill.'

5 Discussions

This research offers an understanding of the intention to donate via m-payment apps as online platforms for donation. This study investigates the influence of donor-related

Table 8 Result of R² and Q²

Constructs	R Square	Q Square
Affective commitment	0.429	0.308
Attitude towards helping others	0.001	0.00
Donor-brand engagement	0.653	0.36
Intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.549	0.34
Intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps	0.152	0.126

Table 9 Effect Sizes (f^2) of the Latent Variables

Structural Path	Effect Size (f^2)	Rating
Donor involvement→ donor-brand engagement	0.446	Large
Donor involvement→ donors' affective commitment	0.128	Medium
Charity reputation→ donor-brand engagement	0.346	Large
Donor-brand engagement→ donors' affective commitment	0.078	Medium
Donor-brand engagement→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.09	Medium
Affective commitment→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.019	Small
Attitude toward helping others→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.022	Small
Helpers' high→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.09	Medium
Religiosity→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.003	Small
Religiosity→ attitude toward helping others	0.001	Small
Effort expectancy→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.007	Small
System trust→ intention to donate via m-payment apps	0.028	Small
Intention to donate via m-payment apps→ intention to recommend donating via m-payment apps	0.18	Large

factors, system-related factors, and brand-related factors on the intention to donate via m-payment apps, and on the extent to which donors will be likely to recommend donating via this platform.

This investigation proposes a model of the antecedents and consequences of donor-brand engagement in which charity reputation and donor involvement are the antecedents, and affective commitment and the intention to donate via m-payment apps are the consequences. The analysis of this model showed that donor-brand engagement exerted a highly significant influence on the intention to donate via m-payment apps. The drivers of engagement that have been suggested by the literature in the context of charities and non-profit organizations (Bennett 2013, Algharabat et al. 2018) offered a sound explanation of donor-brand engagement in the context of donating via m-payment apps. In the context of charities as organizations that offer intangible services,

Table 10 Data for importance-performance map for Intention to donate via m-payment app

Constructs	Importance (total effects)	Performance
Affective Commitment	0.122	75.903
Attitude towards helping others	0.132	85.253
Donor-brand engagement	0.357	84.552
Charity Reputation	0.152	83.901
Donor Involvement	0.221	79.706
Effort Expectancy	0.063	75.434
Helper's High	0.257	73.721
Religiosity	-0.031	84.934
System Trust	0.113	88.474

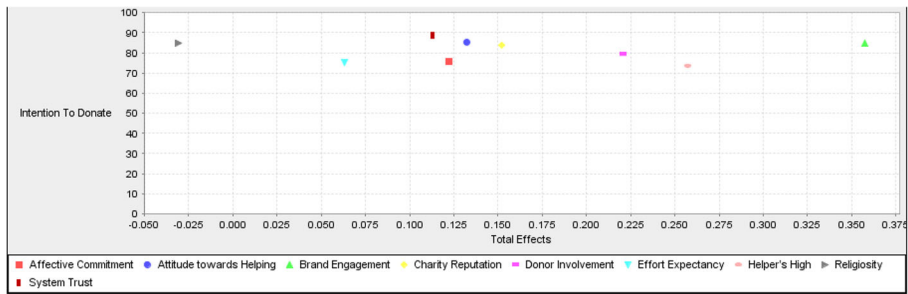


Fig. 2 Importance-Performance map for Intention to donate via m-payment apps

reputation plays a vital role in convincing donors to make contributions (Meijer, 2009). Reputation influences donors' experiences and makes it develop by deeply embedding the charity values in its activities. So, charities with an excellent reputation are expected to create high levels of engagement. Also, the involved donors have a remarkable relevance to a branded charity. Thus donor involvement is an antecedent of donor engagement, and a higher level of involvement leads to a higher level of engagement. Likewise, a strong feeling of involvement boosts affective commitment. Involvement, as the perceived relevance to the charity according to the donors' inherent needs, values, and interests, influences affective commitment.

Engaged donors are highly likely to donate via m-payment apps that are similar to the results of previous researches (Bennett 2013, Algharabat et al. 2018) in the context of donation. The donor-brand engagement, which involves dedication to the branded charity, goes beyond involvement to affective commitment to donation. Engagement engenders a close and strong bond between donors and the branded charity. Engaged donors would be eager to maintain the valued relationship by developing affective commitment, which is a psychological attachment to the branded charity who is their partner in this relationship.

Moreover, affectively committed donors feel a more emotional bond with the branded charity. These donors have a greater tendency to donate via m-payment apps. Commitment and donation intention are related concepts. There is a significant relationship between the level of a donor's commitment and her/his intention to donate (Merchant, Ford and Rose 2011). Individuals who are engaged in charity are more likely to perceive themselves as committed donors to the charity. The affectively committed donors have a high tendency to remain adherent to their commitment to the charity and make donations via m-payment apps.

In this study, attitude toward helping others, helper's high, and religiosity were investigated as donor-related factors. Results show that attitude toward helping others and helper's high affect the intention to donate via m-payment apps positively. These results are supported by previous studies (Bennett 2006; Veludo-de-Oliveira et al. 2017; Bennett 2018; Kwak et al. 2018; Allred and Amos 2018). Attitude toward helping others can be influenced by social-cultural phenomena and beliefs (Roberts & David, 2019), but the helper's high arises from the experience of positive inner

emotion and donors' self-esteem. The effect of religiosity on attitude toward helping others and intention to donate via m-payment apps were insignificant, which is in line with the studies of Lwin et al. (2014) and Arli & Lasmono (2015), but are counter to Roberts & David (2019). Iran is a Muslim country, but religion does not necessarily affect donors' intention to donate and attitude toward helping others. According to Finney (1978), religious commitment has a different dimension, including ritual practice, knowledge, experience, belief, and devotional practice. In Iran, religious teachings are often concentrated on ritual practices rather than the devotional practice, which can be due to the dominance of jurisprudence. On the other hand, all religious commitment dimensions have not necessarily developed evenly in a religious person; in other words, all religious commitment may not be seen in religious individuals' behaviors and intentions.

On the one hand, donors remain anonymous when donating via m-payment apps; hence primary donation motivations may be restricted to internalized ones. On the other hand, in the theory of the leisure class, Veblen (1899) considers conspicuous consumption as a way of showing wealth and social status. He refers to the concept of conspicuous consumption as consumption, not merely to satisfy needs, but also to acquire greater respect and dignity and resemblance to the upper classes in modern and urban societies. Furthermore, conspicuous displays of different affiliations such as religious affiliations are a way of signaling belonging to a special social group and represent a person's perceived or actual place in that society (Johnson and Tariq 2016). According to the results of this study, it can be concluded that Iranian religious donors are motivated by a desire to be seen as responsible members of the religious society, and consequently be awarded social esteem. As the identity of donors remains unknown when donating via m-payment apps, Iranian religious donors would not be motivated only by altruistic reasons.

Effort expectancy and trust in the m-payment system were examined as m-payment system-related factors affecting the intention to donate via m-payment apps. Effort expectancy does not influence the intention to donate via m-payment apps. However, effort expectancy has been acknowledged as an effective factor in the early stages of the adoption of m-payment; since charity is one of the newly added services to m-payment apps, it has become easier for users to use these apps. On the other hand, the process of donating via m-payment apps is effortless and has no complexity. So, effort expectancy does not significantly affect donations via m-payment apps.

M-payment technology is well-known and has passed its early stages and has now been proliferated; therefore, it is trusted by consumers. In other words, the m-payment transaction process satisfies consumers' expectations. The reason is that if anything goes wrong, or something contrary to consumer expectations occurs, consumers would just stop using m-payment apps and move onto another transfer method. So, trust in the m-payment system plays an important role in consumers' intention to use it. Trust in an m-payment system affects donors' intention to donate via m-payment apps as a method of monetary transfer.

As can be seen, helper's high which is in the lowest right area of the importance-performance map, has high importance for the intention to donate via m-payment apps, but shows the lowest performance. Thus, there is a notably high potential for improving the performance of the intention to donate via m-payment apps by concentrating on helper's high. In addition, helper's high would possibly prohibit the donors from

distinguishing between or involving in charity organizations, and experiencing the warm glow of giving could be an incentive to donate via m-payment apps. So, reputation and involvement are less important than the act of donation.

Moreover, m-payment system-related factors have lower importance relative to the other constructs (donor-related factors and charity brand-related factors) in the importance-performance map, and have a lower priority for performance improvements. Hence investing in the performance improvement of m-payment system-related factors which have very small importance for improving the intention to donate via m-payment apps would not be logical. However, m-payment apps remove restrictions on time and location and help users to transfer money anytime and anywhere. Passing the early stages of proliferation facilitates the technology and makes it a simple operation for users. But, regardless of effort expectancy, if the user sees the advantages of using the m-payment system are incompatible with the intended purpose, he or she may not be willing to use m-payment for transferring money (Oliveira et al. 2016). According to the theory of social exchange, if donation via m-payment apps does not have any special social benefits for the donor, the incompatibility with the donors' need for social exchange dissuades him or her from donating via m-payment.

Furthermore, religiosity has the lowest importance but relatively high performance. So, focusing on religious donors to create a stronger intention to donate via m-payment apps is a wasted effort.

6 Conclusion and implication

This study aims to examine the impact of donor-related factors (helper's high, religiosity, and attitude toward helping others), m-payment system-related factors (system trust, and effort expectancy) and charity brand-related factors (a donor-brand engagement model) on the intention to donate via m-payment apps and intention to recommend this technology to others. This research suggests a donor-brand engagement in which charity reputation and donor involvement are the antecedents, and affective commitment and intention to donate via m-payment apps are the consequences of donor-brand engagement.

As the donation payment method influences tangible and intangible costs and benefits, donation via m-payment would contribute to the donation intention. Donation via m-payment apps would affect the market segmentation and target group selection process of charities. Patently, wealthy donors who seek social status by donating in public are not the target group anymore. Donating via m-payment apps, the donors remain unknown, and the donor is not directly observable. Remaining unknown will affect donors' donation intention. So, charities need to revise the demands and needs of their target group.

Self and social identities are important factors contributing to donation intention. Since in the context of donation via m-payment apps social identity is not salient, the donors' intention to donate via m-payment apps should match his/her self-identity. According to Terry et al. (1999) the influence of self-identity on behavioral intention is not dependent on whether the behavior had been performed in the past or not. So self-identity would motivate individual donation intention if the charity is one that the person has already engaged with (an engaged donor), or one that motivates a donor to

support at that moment in time from the shortlist of charity brands (e.g., due to the awareness of the issue).

On the other hand, as charity brands are a focal cue for donors engaging in pro-social behavior, charities need strong brands more than ever. A strong brand is well-known to the target groups of the charity (Wymer et al. 2016), and has a good chance of being selected by donors in a shortlist of the m-payment app.

As the results show in this study, donor-brand engagement is the most crucial factor in donation intention via m-payment apps in Iran. So, charities need to enhance donors' engagement. On the other hand, donors' involvement and the charity's reputation are important constructs in explaining donor-brand engagement. Thus charities can get more engagement from donors by intensifying donors' involvement and the charity's reputation.

Charities can hold meetings with donors and talk about their activities. By providing opportunities for effective interaction, charities can raise donors' perceived relevance and feelings of identification, which leads to donors' involvement and, in turn, engenders engaged donors. Likewise, charities need to consider effective communication strategies that speak to their donors. Also, they should connect with donors, whose donations they rely on, and inform them about the positive differences their activities have made to people's lives. This can raise awareness about the charity's reputation. Furthermore, as the need for social representation and identification is a driver of commitment (Bloemer and Odekerken-Schröder 2003), it is important that donors feel they are a part of the conversations and communications. So, the meetings and effective interactions between charities and donors can boost donors' affective commitment and engagement, which, in turn, causes greater future intention to donate via m-payment apps.

Since engagement is the donors' pride and passion for the branded charity, it derives from the psychological and interactive bond between the donors and branded charities, the charity managers should focus on the application of relationship marketing as an instrument for sustaining the donor-brand relationship and connection.

Moreover, sharing experiences with others is likely to make donors feel more engaged in a brand (Bennett 2013), so a growth in brand engagement can lead to stronger tendencies to recommend donating to the respective charity via m-payment apps. Thus, as the most valuable asset of charity brands is their ability to achieve positive differentiation in the minds of their donors, branding strategies should be applied to attract more engaged donors.

The helper's high is the second most important construct that affects the intention to donate via m-payment apps in this study. Pro-social behavior including donating money to charities creates a pleasurable "helper's high" that benefits the giver. Rudd et al. (2014) believe that "the hedonic benefit givers receive from their pro-social acts depends, at least in part, on the degree to which givers perceive that their actions had the desired pro-social effect". So, if the donors know that their donation made a positive difference in other people's lives, they feel more positive emotions and happiness. Thus, charities can boost helper's high, and consequently, the intention to donate via m-payment apps by defining a tracking code. A tracking code can specify the final pro-social effect of a donation, and donors would be influenced by the desired pro-social effect which their donations have created.

Despite the fact that m-payment system-related factors may be important in the early stages of development and adoption of these technologies, they are not sufficient to

persuade donors to donate via m-payment apps. So, m-payment app providers should design these apps considering donors' involvement and engagement in a way that donors are inspired to donate via m-payment apps. Involved consumers contemplate the future benefit of the relationship (Carvalho and Fernandes 2018). Thus, as expressed by the social exchange theory, cost-benefit analysis of involved consumers causes dedication and commitment (Osei-Frimpong and McLean 2018). Conforming to social exchange theory, donations are a result of cost-benefit analysis in that donors compare the benefits of donating against the cost of such behavior. So, app providers can suggest free services according to the donation sum or frequency of donation via m-payment apps, which can be considered as benefits of donating via m-payment apps. As a consequence, donors would receive the intangible benefit of donating via m-payment for the tangible benefit of using free services.

Users' tendency to recommend a technology can be pivotal post-adoption behavior, the result of which is standing out in the respective market. In comparison to other recent studies (Miltgen et al. 2013; Oliveira et al. 2016; Verkijika 2020) that have investigated the impact of intention to use other information technology services on recommending using the technologies to others, this study shows a lower value of the variance when it comes to recommendation. Vargo (2016) stated that consumers would share information with friends in order to give them a chance to receive tangible value, considerable gain, and benefit or free things. Also, Saxton (1995), believed "The environmental motivation is the simplest of forces: people do things because their peers are doing it, or their immediate environment will change, or they may directly benefit". So, charity managers should offer giveaways, grants, or other obvious beneficial suggestions as ways to encourage donors to recommend donating via m-payment apps.

According to the demographic information of the sample, relatively young middle-income donors can be a good target market for charities looking to achieve fundraising goals via an online platform such as m-payment apps. They are more inclined to use technology, and due to their middle-income, their donation sums are possibly small. So, they would prefer anonymity to conspicuous giving.

7 Future directions

Like any empirical study, this study is subject to limitations that future research can overcome. Since donation is a social-cultural behavior, more cross-cultural investigation of intention to donate via m-payment apps should be done. Also, more research should be done into the branding strategies in the context of donation via online platforms especially m-payment apps. Furthermore, future research may study to what extent technology-mediated or mobile-mediated civic engagement is welcomed in religious societies.

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